



PERSPECTIVES

SPRING 2026
Volume 4, Issue 1



PHILANTHROPY

Continuity * Commitment * Community

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PERSPECTIVES

is the official publication of CALUNAH produced by a dedicated editorial team to share news and reflections with alumni, friends, and supporters.

The opinions expressed in contributed articles are solely those of the authors and do not necessarily reflect the views of the editorial team or organization.

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IN THIS ISSUE

Volume 4, Issue 1, SPRING 2026

1. Cover Page
2. Table of Contents
3. Editorial
4. Executive President Message
5. Philanthropy: A Life-Transforming Ministry
7. God's Light in Times of Need: CALUNAH's Mission of Hope
8. Rebondir Pour Un Nouveau Départ
- 9-11. In the Loop / Actualités
12. News from UNAH
13. The Christian and the Preservation of Mental Health
- 14-16. Alumni Voices
17. Caprices du français
18. Remembering
19. Philanthropy and Christianity
20. Back Cover

OUR MISSION:

CALUNAH is dedicated to provide scholarships and financial assistance toward maintaining student learning and school infrastructure.

Our humanitarian mission is sans frontières (without borders) which means that we endeavor to support students from all walks of life.

OUR VISION:

To build strong communities in both Haiti and abroad through education and communal engagement.

Cover photo:

The Veterans Memorial Bridge in Daytona Beach, Florida, illuminated over the Halifax River.

Credit: LDSL





The Architecture of Compassion

Dear reader,
Chère lectrice, cher lecteur,

Recently, I was chatting with a colleague when the theme for this edition, philanthropy, came up. As we considered it, I mentioned an image I had in mind: a beautiful bridge envisioned through a series of abstract concepts, all deliberately beginning with the letter “C.” He immediately suggested: Connection to which I added Communication, Compassion before our conversation drifted to another topic of discussion.

En réfléchissant à l'essence de notre organisation, la philanthropie, we find ourselves standing on a bridge, not as a destination, but **as a luminous passage upheld by 5 architectural pillars** resting on a firm foundation. Better yet, we are crossing this bridge... some of us slowly, others quickly; some smilingly, others thoughtfully; yet all of us driven by one common idea: this structure rests upon a solid foundation. Conscience, the quiet inner belief, invites us to **step onto the bridge** even when the pathway feels dim. Isn't it Conscience that calls us to speak with integrity, to move with determination, to reach out in compassion toward others? And there, beside it, lies another part of the foundation: Compassion, the quiet mobilizer beneath the five visible pillars. And as we walk, we realize that we're not alone, but together.

It is along this passage that these “C” s take shape naturally:

C-Communication, first step that moves us to speak truthfully, aligning itself with
C-Connection that binds us with the *‘love thy neighbor as thyself’* in mind, while moving to
C-Community, sharing space, where belonging replaces social, religious, financial gaps through
C-Contribution, expression of care, generosity in motion, pillar of service leading to
C-Commitment the enduring force that keeps the architecture from collapsing.

Notre organisation a toujours été ce type de pont qui nous invite à avancer ensemble. These concepts are not abstract; they take form in CALUNAH itself, where everyone shaped by its mission reflects this shared vision. We cross with assurance because the architecture is held steady not by a pillar, not by a foundation, but by **Christ, the anchor**. The reflections shared in this edition reveal how CALUNAH's mission continues to live through those who walk with us, whether alumni or friends. As you read, what personal “C” do you carry into this humanitarian calling today?

Happy reading,
Bonne lecture!

Philanthropy & CALUNAH's Goals for 2026

Annie Nadine Benoit



Education is one of the most powerful forms of philanthropy because it transforms lives and strengthens communities. When we invest in education, we **invest in hope, dignity, and opportunity**. A scholarship, a backpack of supplies, or a safe learning space can shape a child's future and uplift a family for generations.

Educational philanthropy goes **beyond** academics. It nurtures character, critical thinking, and purpose. It prepares learners to become leaders, problem-solvers, and compassionate citizens. By opening doors to employment and lifelong learning, education breaks cycles of poverty and creates lasting change.

At its heart, educational philanthropy is a partnership among donors, educators, families, and communities who believe every child deserves access to quality learning.

When we give toward education, we plant seeds that will bear fruit long into the future. Empowered minds strengthen communities, and generosity multiplies far beyond what we can see today.

As President of CALUNAH, I am honored to share our key goals for 2026. Our mission remains rooted in the belief that **education is transformative**, and that investing in learners builds stronger communities and a brighter future.

Our 2026 Goals

- **Spiritual Foundation:** We began the year with a Week of Prayer under the theme *"Renewed Hearts, Restored Relationships."* Pastor Gerly Germain, Chaplain Judith Jean-Baptiste, and Dr. Nathanael Gracia led us in meaningful moments of worship and reflection.
- **Expanding Our Reach:** CALUNAH plans to establish a new chapter in either the Northeast or South-Central region to reach more students, engage alumni and friends, and strengthen local partnerships.
- **Financial Sustainability:** We will launch a transparent fundraising tracker with a goal of raising **\$150,000 by December 2026**, and we aim to welcome 200 recurring supporters through

our website to ensure consistent support for students.

- **Community Engagement:** We will host two major initiatives—a **Fundraising Concert** and our annual Saturday Giving—along with our **Backpack Drive**, which provides essential school supplies to students in need.
- **Growing Our Team:** We seek advocates, volunteers, and partners who share our passion for empowering students through education.
- Together, these goals reflect CALUNAH's commitment to education, faith, and service. With collective support, 2026 will be a year of growth, impact, and meaningful investment in the next generation.

Yours truly,

Annie Nadine Benoit

Philanthropy: A Life-Transforming Ministry

Living a faith that gives, serves, and transforms

Jean Monestime

The Christian faith values altruism, the belief that leads us to place the needs of others before our own, to love without condition, and to serve without expectation. Yet if selfless service is central to our belief system, why have we struggled to build a more philanthropic culture? Why do so many Christians still consider themselves financially poor? And how do we develop the knowledge and confidence to become better stewards of our resources?

Giving, even when it feels like our last strength, is faith in action.

In *The Analects*, the Chinese philosopher Confucius emphasizes the importance of rigorously maintaining a **virtuous lifestyle** and acting in accordance with our values. When our values guide us, our ministry becomes fluid and effective. Jesus Christ Himself exemplified this through His ministry as a selfless servant. By following His example, we can sow seeds of righteousness in the lives of others. This concept may be understood as the Ministry of Transformation, or **philanthropy**, the kind of ministry that invites those around us to experience our love in practical, meaningful ways. It reflects a commitment to changing lives through action rather than words.

Without philanthropy, without the act of giving selflessly, our faith in action remains incomplete. Philanthropy is a resource invested today by a few, with the hope of creating a brighter future for many. While some refer to this as Christian stewardship, it is important to distinguish the two. Christian stewardship focuses on the responsible management of one's resources. Philanthropy, however, is the **act of giving without expecting anything in return**.

In the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus declared, "Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be filled." True righteousness is not achieved merely through faithfully returning tithes and offerings, especially when done out of fear. Nor is it found in philanthropic acts performed for self-promotion. Instead, righteousness grows in those who choose to make a life of virtue their daily practice, those who actively help others bear their burdens.

As people of faith, the way we minister to those around us reveals whether we are living a virtuous life. To be virtuous is to live in harmony with our beliefs and values. This is not the same as being holy, for none of us are holy. Yet as we strive toward virtue, we discover that righteousness is cultivated through ministry, through giving, caring, and lifting others up. In this way, righteousness becomes the seed nurtured by our acts of service.



"We are not only stewards, but we are also carriers of blessings."

A farmer plants the crop and then prays for rain. This is an act of faith. Likewise, we must sow even when we do not know when the harvest will come. Like the widow in 1 Kings 17, we must trust that God is in control, especially when we choose to do what is right. He will never "forsake the righteous or allow their children to beg for bread" (Psalm 37:25). When we care for others, God's Spirit speaks to our hearts and assures us that giving, even when it feels like our last bit of sustenance, is good. That is **faith in action**. Just as He cared for the widow of Zarephath, God knows how to care for us in ways beyond our imagination. To doubt this is to misunderstand Christ's teaching when He faced the hungry multitude.

To be philanthropic in our mission is to recognize that we are not only stewards, but we are also ministers, benefactors, and carriers of blessings. We become better stewards when we focus on the impact our resources can make in someone's life, rather than turning away when help is needed. All that we possess has been entrusted to us for the benefit of those we serve, and sharing these resources should bring us joy.

This mindset nurtures a society where **selfless giving** uplifts others, rather than one where generosity is limited to surplus we never truly needed.

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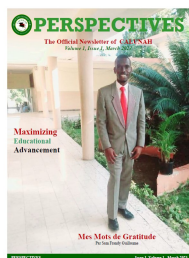
In *The Prophet*, Khalil Gibran writes of giving: “There are those who have little and give it all. These are believers in life, and their coffer is never empty... There are those who give with joy, and that joy is their reward... and there are those who give and know not pain in giving, nor do they seek joy; through the hands of such as these, God speaks, and behind their eyes, He smiles upon the earth. All you have shall someday be given away; therefore, give now, that the season of giving may be yours and not your inheritors’.”

True philanthropy is never a sacrifice; it is a **selfless act rooted in love and respect** for the dignity of the recipient. This kind of ministry transforms lives, making the impossible possible for those we assist. It is what distinguishes those who thrive from those who merely survive, those who embrace abundance from those who

remain trapped in scarcity. There is a profound difference between individuals who practice true philanthropy and those who live without regard for others, forgetting that fellow human beings depend on their generosity and ministry.

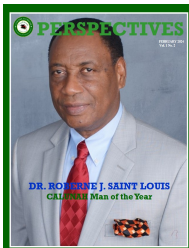
As Dr. Cornel West reminds us, “We cannot save the people if we don’t serve the people.” May we choose to serve others through the transformative power of philanthropic ministry. 🗨️

Jean Monestime, MBA, is a former Miami-Dade County Commissioner and Chairman Emeritus with a long-standing commitment to faith-based service. A dedicated SDA church member, he has served in various leadership roles, including First Elder.



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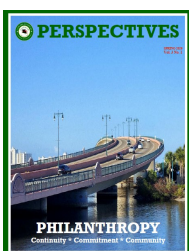
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Together, we make a meaningful difference.

God's Light in Times of Need: CALUNAH's Mission of Hope

Philanthropy in action through faith and service

Hope Duhaney-Sangster



God is the source of life, light, and joy, for “every good gift and every perfect gift is from above” (James 1:17). Christ, “the way, the truth, and the life” (John 14:6), continues His work through those who follow Him, inviting us to reflect His goodness and share His compassion with a world in need.

In October 2025, Hurricane Melissa, a violent Category 5 storm, swept across Jamaica, Haïti, and Cuba, leaving behind flooding, destroyed homes, and widespread disruption. Haïti, already burdened by years of hardship, faced even greater challenges. In such moments of loss, God invites His children to lean on Him more fully. Communities continue striving toward recovery, yet the needs remain overwhelming.

“CALUNAH has been a bright and steady light to the Adventist University of Haiti for more than thirty-two years.”

One steady source of hope is CALUNAH, a nonprofit formed by devoted alumni and friends. For more than three decades, they have strengthened the Adventist University of Haïti through scholarships, school materials, facility upgrades, and community initiatives. Their generosity reflects deep gratitude for an institution that shaped their lives, and their **impact** continues to **inspire** supporters worldwide.

I was introduced to CALUNAH years ago through a mutual friend and was moved by the **sincerity and passion** I witnessed in the couple who first welcomed me. That encounter deepened my appreciation for CALUNAH's mission and its impact on the Adventist University of Haïti. Their commitment inspired me to do my part, and after sharing the mission with alumni and friends, I witnessed remarkable generosity. Although I am not Haitian, I clearly saw the value of CALUNAH's work and the vision behind it. Supporting this mission has enriched my life and drawn me more deeply into the compassionate work God calls us to do.

“Supporting CALUNAH allows us to take part in the compassionate work God calls us to faithfully do together.”

Now more than ever, Haïti's youth need hope, opportunity, and access to quality education. By supporting CALUNAH, we help build a stronger future for generations to come. As you consider contributing, remember that **God sees every act of generosity** and is able to multiply your gifts. May we each do our part - through our prayers and contributions - as God guides CALUNAH with renewed strength and purpose. ■

Hope Duhaney-Sangster, M.A. is a Jamaican-born educator trained in Manchester, England. She taught in both England and Jamaica and was among the founding pioneers of HEART Trust, helping establish vocational academies across the island. Retired after more than twenty years of service, she is a mother of three, grandmother of nine, and the author of five books of stories and poems.

Rebondir Pour Un Nouveau Départ

Choisir la résilience et l'engagement face aux épreuves

Bordes Henry-Saturné

Pourquoi certaines personnes se laissent-elles abattre par les circonstances difficiles, tandis que d'autres semblent puiser dans une source inépuisable de courage pour lutter et triompher, même face à des obstacles apparemment insurmontables ? Nous ne contrôlons pas toujours les événements de notre vie. En revanche, nous pouvons tous choisir la manière dont nous y réagissons.



Selon Viktor Frankl, survivant des atrocités d'Auschwitz, la liberté la plus précieuse demeure celle de **choisir notre attitude**. Tout peut nous être enlevé, sauf cette capacité intérieure : décider qui nous devenons moralement et spirituellement, créer un espace entre le stimulus et la réponse, et y exercer notre liberté.

« Nous ne contrôlons pas toujours les événements de notre vie. En revanche, nous pouvons tous choisir la manière dont nous y réagissons. »

Ellen G. White renforce cette idée en rappelant que « chaque être humain, créé à l'image de Dieu, possède le pouvoir personnel de penser et d'agir. » ... La véritable éducation, dit-elle, consiste à développer ce pouvoir : former des hommes et des femmes capables de réfléchir par eux-mêmes, de dominer les circonstances plutôt que de les subir, et d'avoir le courage de leurs convictions.

David, face à la persécution injuste du roi Saül, a su garder la tête haute et conserver sa maîtrise de soi. De même, le peuple haïtien, trop souvent érigé en bouc émissaire, a toujours choisi la voie de la dignité. Dans le sillage de Capois-la-Mort, Vertières, Dessalines et de la Crête-à-Pierrot, il a opposé une résistance patiente, intelligente, héroïque et intrépide aux menaces et aux exactions.

À chacun de nous revient cette **décision essentielle** face

aux vicissitudes de la vie :

Serons-nous fragiles comme un œuf qui se brise lorsqu'il tombe ? Ou serons-nous comme une balle de tennis qui rebondit toujours plus haut lorsqu'elle est projetée au sol ?

C'est un choix auquel chaque ancien élève de Diquini est appelé. La résilience est cette capacité à traverser les obstacles, à se relever après les épreuves et à s'ajuster malgré les traumatismes. Notre force intérieure devient **irrésistible** lorsque nous sommes **mentalement prêts à rebondir** pour un nouveau départ, quelles que soient nos circonstances. Comme le dit le cantique :

« Poursuivons notre course avec persévérance, et que rien ici-bas n'entrave notre ardeur. »

Tournerons-nous le dos à notre mère patrie, à nos racines, aux institutions qui ont contribué à notre réussite ?

Ou manifesterons-nous notre reconnaissance en soutenant une noble cause selon nos moyens ?

Baïsserons-nous les bras ou crierons-nous : « En avant ! »

La contribution de chacun sera différente, mais **tous peuvent participer**. Soyons des fils et des filles dignes de notre fière patrie. ■

Bordes Henry Saturné, Ph.D. est un éducateur, pasteur, auteur et missionnaire d'outre-mer. Il est actuellement vice-président à l'Université adventiste Andrews, au Michigan.

“Life is not about waiting for the storms to pass but learning to dance in the rain.”

Vivian Greene

New England Chapter — Toy Drive Initiative & CALUNAH Day

Gregory Meleance, President

The CALUNAH Chapter successfully organized and implemented a Toy Drive initiative on December 14, 2025, serving multiple communities across Fitchburg, Lynn, Brockton, and Rhode Island. This effort was carried out in collaboration with local churches and community-based organizations, ensuring broad outreach and effective distribution of resources to families in need.

The primary objective of the Toy Drive was to provide toys and essential items to underprivileged children during the holiday season. Through

coordinated planning and partnership, the Chapter was able to identify families facing economic hardship and deliver meaningful support that contributed to a more joyful and inclusive holiday experience.

In addition to meeting immediate community needs, the initiative strengthened CALUNAH's presence and visibility within the regions served. By working alongside trusted local institutions, the Chapter reinforced its commitment to service, compassion, and community engagement. These partnerships also helped build lasting relationships that can

support future outreach efforts.

Overall, the CALUNAH Toy Drive exemplified the Chapter's mission to support community well-being. By addressing both material needs and social connection, the initiative contributed to stronger, more resilient communities while embodying the principles of service and collective uplift.



The CALUNAH NEC successfully hosted its CALUNAH Day on July 19, 2025, at Temple Salem in Dorchester, Massachusetts. The event brought together members and guests for a day of fellowship, reflection, and community building.

A highlight of the program was the presentation delivered by Dr. Frantz

D'Haïti, whose message inspired and engaged attendees. Following the formal session, participants enjoyed a warm and welcoming luncheon, which provided an opportunity for meaningful interaction and strengthened relationships among members.

The event also contributed to the growth of the Chapter, as 10 new

individuals were added to the membership roster. This outcome reflects the continued vitality and appeal of CALUNAH's mission and activities. Overall, NEC Day was a successful gathering that fostered unity, encouraged engagement, and supported the Chapter's ongoing development.



New York Chapter — Social Activity & CALUNAH Day

Mackensdy Dormeus, President

Les activités de fin d'année du Chapitre de New York ont été marquées par l'organisation d'un Meet and Greet avec échange de cadeaux, tenu le dimanche 7 décembre 2025.

Cet événement a favorisé la convivialité, le renforcement des liens fraternels et l'intégration de nouveaux participants. Il a réuni 24 membres actifs et 7 nouveaux partici-

pants, permettant l'intégration effective de 7 nouveaux membres.

À l'issue de cette activité, l'effectif du chapitre est passé de 31 à 38 membres actifs, traduisant une dynamique de croissance positive en clôture de l'exercice 2025.



Le culte d'adoration du 28 mars 2026 restera gravé dans la mémoire des enfants de Dieu de l'église de Mid-Hudson, située dans la région du nord de l'État de New York.

Plus d'une trentaine de membres du chapitre de New York ont quitté Brooklyn, Queens et Long Island pour rejoindre leurs coreligionnaires de la Mid-Hudson SDA Church, dans le cadre des visites trimestrielles organisées par les dirigeants du chapitre de New York.

Cette toute première initiative a connu un succès remarquable. Le jeune prédicateur, Markdeve Dormeus, a partagé un message encourageant qui a motivé les membres de la congrégation à poursuivre leur engagement spirituel.

Des plaques d'appréciation ont été remises, des gerbes de fleurs distribuées, et l'hospitalité de la congrégation s'est révélée particulièrement chaleureuse. Une réception, soigneusement préparée par de talen-

teux cordons bleus, a également été offerte aux participants.

Toute la gloire revient à Dieu. Des paroles d'encouragement et de bénédiction ont été adressées aux dirigeants, aux membres du chapitre, ainsi qu'un message d'appréciation tout particulier à la congrégation et au leadership de l'église de Mid-Hudson, dans l'État de New York.



Central Florida Chapter — CALUNAH Days

Ercie Louis, Présidente

Le sabbat du 23 octobre 2025, le chapitre du Centre de la Floride (CFC) a organisé un sabbat spécial à l'église Adventiste Salem à Jacksonville, Floride. Cet événement spirituel a rassemblé de nombreux membres et invités dans une atmosphère de recueillement, de fraternité et de louange.

Le culte a été marqué par la présence du pasteur Othnie Valcourt

en tant que prédicateur invité. À travers un message inspirant et profondément spirituel, il a encouragé l'assemblée à renforcer sa foi, à demeurer fidèle dans les épreuves et à cultiver une relation personnelle avec Dieu et à soutenir l'Université adventiste D'Haiti dans sa mission d'éducation.

Les chants, les prières et les différentes interventions ont contribué

à créer un moment d'édification et de communion fraternelle. Ce CALUNAH Sabbath restera gravé dans les mémoires comme une occasion de renouveau spirituel et d'unité au sein de la communauté.

CFC se réjouit du succès de cette rencontre et exprime sa gratitude envers tous ceux qui ont contribué à son organisation et à sa réalisation.



On February 28, 2026, the Sabbath service at Bethanie Seventh-day Adventist Church was marked by a special program organized by CALUNAH Central Florida. The congregation gathered under the leadership of Pastor Lucens Joseph for a spiritually enriching service

centered on worship, reflection, and fellowship.

The program featured guest speaker Dr. Judith Gabriel, a medical doctor and medical missionary, who delivered an inspiring message of faith and service. Musical segments added

to the atmosphere of worship, including a vocal performance by guest singer Dr. Ketia Cherenfant and special instrumental interpretations, notably a saxophone selection by Godson Pierre that enhanced the spirit of the occasion.



Unification du Système Universitaire

Fritz Noel

L'Université Adventiste d'Haïti (UNAH) poursuit sa mission d'enseignement supérieur en renforçant sa présence nationale et en modernisant ses outils de communication. Le Rectorat et le Département des Communications informent la famille universitaire et les Alumni de deux décisions majeures prises en cette fin d'année 2025.

Actualisation de l'identité visuelle

Le 22 octobre 2025, l'UNAH a présenté une identité visuelle actualisée, mieux alignée sur sa mission et ses valeurs.

Une période de transition d'un an (octobre 2025 – octobre 2026) permettra son intégration progressive. Une charte graphique officielle accompagne cette mise à jour pour harmoniser l'usage de la nouvelle image.

Unification du système universitaire: Campus Michel Nord Isaac
Par communiqué du 1er décembre

2025, le Rectorat confirme une avancée stratégique : après les Gonaïves, l'UNAH est désormais officiellement implantée dans le Nord, au Cap-Haïtien. Dans le cadre du plan de l'Église visant un système universitaire unifié, l'Université Michel Nord Isaac devient **Université Adventiste d'Haïti : campus Michel Nord Isaac**. Cette intégration renforce les facultés déjà présentes au Cap-Haïtien, notamment en génie civil, agronomie, sciences infirmières et biologie médicale.

Sur le plan administratif, le système repose sur un Rectorat unique, basé à Diquini, qui supervise les trois campus (Diquini, Gonaïves, Cap-Haïtien) grâce à des représentants locaux assurant la coordination et l'unité de direction.

Cette extension ouvre de nouvelles perspectives de formation, de service et de croissance pour la région, tout en garantissant une éducation

conforme aux standards académiques et aux valeurs adventistes.

Reconnaissance et mission

Le Dr Sénèque Edmond, Recteur de l'UNAH, exprime sa gratitude envers Dieu pour cette étape importante dans l'enseignement supérieur adventiste en Haïti. L'université continue de compter sur l'engagement de ses diplômés pour porter l'étendard de la « Voie du Service ».

Informations institutionnelles

- **Siège:** Diquini 63, Carrefour, Haïti
- **Site web:** unah.edu.ht
- **Contact:** +509 28 13 11 11

Pasteur Fritz Noel, Vice-Recteur aux Affaires étudiantes



The Christian and the Preservation of Mental Health

Finding peace, resilience, and faith in a world filled with stress and uncertainty

Jean-Guy Honoré

Dear readers, we are living in difficult and stressful times, much like those Jesus foretold when He said, “You will hear of wars and rumors of wars; see that you are not alarmed.” Around the world, we witness conflicts, disasters, and crises, events that create anxiety and place a heavy strain on our mental well-being. As Christians, we must therefore be intentional about preserving our inner balance and caring for our minds.

Is it possible to maintain mental health in such an environment? While the causes of stress vary from one region to another, their effects on health remain remarkably similar. The World Health Organization defines mental health as a state in which individuals can cope with life’s pressures, learn, work, and contribute to their community. It is an essential component of overall well-being.

God has always desired wholeness for His people, including a sound mind. In 3 John 2, the apostle writes, “Be healthy, just as your soul prospers.” Today, **more than one billion people worldwide** are affected by mental disorders. To remain mentally strong, we must cultivate a positive outlook and place our trust in God. The mind greatly influences the body, and our response to difficulties often shapes our overall health. Many young people now face illnesses such as hypertension, diabetes, and cancer, with stress being a significant contributing factor.

External stress does not necessarily become internal stress.

Proverbs 17:22 reminds us that “a cheerful heart is good medicine,” highlighting the physical impact of emotional distress. Modern medicine confirms that many conditions are psychosomatic, triggered or worsened by stress, intense emotions, or inner conflict. Stress can contribute to asthma, cardiovascular disease, ulcers, eczema, and migraines.

Psychologist Esther Buitekant explains that stress is the body’s natural response to demanding or threatening situations. It is a normal physiological reaction; what varies is how each person handles it. Stress may be tem-

porary or become chronic, disrupting daily life and affecting the nervous system, raising heart rate, blood pressure, and weakening immune defenses. Stress is an unavoidable part of life. Learning to manage it is essential.



What can we do? Identify the source of stress and address it. When situations become harmful—overwork, pressure, harassment—stepping away is often the only path to recovery. Helpful strategies include abdominal breathing, relaxation techniques, regular physical activity, and seeking professional support when needed. Natural remedies may also provide relief.

Among the Adventist Church’s eight natural health principles, one is especially valuable: trust in God. Faith offers a powerful anchor in times of pressure. Philippians 4:6–7 encourages us to bring every concern to God in prayer, resting in His care.

Peace is not found in the absence of pressure, but in the presence of God.

Scripture offers many promises that strengthen mental resilience: Psalm 56:4–5; Psalm 118:6; Proverbs 3:5–6; Luke 12:6–7; Romans 8:38–39; Hebrews 13:6; 2 Timothy 1:7; Matthew 6:31–33. Above all, remember 1 Peter 5:7: “Cast all your anxiety on Him because He cares for you.” ■

* <https://www.who.int/fr/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/mental-health-strengthening-our-response>

Jean-Guy Honoré, MD, MPH, is an obstetrician-gynecologist with specialized training in public health, reproductive health, and colposcopy. He is Professor of Obstetrics at the Faculty of Medicine and Pharmacy of the State University of Haïti, Executive Director of CHARESS, and a Clinical Instructor at the University of Washington in Seattle.

Different Voices, Different Paths / Voix distinctes, différents parcours

In this section, alumni share their journeys, their gratitude, and the wisdom they've gained along the way. Dans cette rubrique, des anciens élèves évoquent leur parcours, leur gratitude et la sagesse qu'ils ont acquise.

Nelie Lubin Mills

We are pleased to spotlight **Nelie Lubin Mills, M.Ed.**, a proud SAFH alumna and educator who, as a school counselor, draws on her experience to support students' personal and academic growth.

Where are you originally from, and how long were you at the school?

Being from Waney, Carrefour, Haïti, I am delighted to share my experiences during my academic year at Séminaire Adventiste Franco-Haïtien (SAFH) in my adolescent years. From a spiritual perspective, **the single year I spent there may be worth a thousand years** in the divine calendar.

After leaving the school, how did your studies or early experiences shape the path you took?

The following year, I moved to the United States to live with my parents and attended public school, as private education was no longer possible for us. By God's grace, I held on to the values and faith I learned at SAFH throughout high school, college, and university.

High school was especially difficult after my father passed away during my senior year, yet the Heavenly Father I had come to know at SAFH remained my strength. These early experiences of faith and perseverance led me to a career in education. Today, as a school counselor, I encourage students to pursue academic success while nurturing their spiritual and personal growth.

In what ways has your personal or family life influenced your career or personal growth?

As I grew as a mother and wife, I came to see how deeply God's presence shaped my school years. I was blessed to receive both Catholic and SDA Christian education, and while I respected the principles of each, I especially felt God's sweet Spirit at SAFH, reaching into every corner of Diquini.

Is there a particular person or experience from your

school years that you are especially grateful for?

Attending this Christian school was a true blessing. Devoted teachers instilled in us biblical principles and academic knowledge. What I remember most is singing and praying together each day. Their patience and kindness created a welcoming environment where we loved coming to school, not only to learn, but to grow together.



Service, compassion, and faith are the foundations for a life that makes a meaningful difference in the world.

In what ways do you support your former school or the alumni community?

I am eternally thankful for the blessings I received at SAFH, and I believe my attendance there was part of God's divine plan. Because of this, I support the University whenever needed: socially, emotionally, or financially. As a member of the Education Team at my church, I also highlight the value of Christian education to the church family and to friends, sharing guidance inspired by my own experiences at SAFH.

What guidance would you offer to current and former students about living a life of service?

I encourage students to trust God's principles, knowing He will bless their efforts and equip them to bless others. My life's work has been to support children through education that nurtures them academically, socially, and emotionally. Service, compassion, and faith remain the foundations of a life that truly makes a difference.

Thank you, Mrs. Mills, for sharing your guidance and your longstanding service to students and the wider community. ▣

Dr. Arthur Pierre-Louis

It's a pleasure to highlight **Dr. Arthur Pierre-Louis**, a distinguished alum of UNAH, whose career as a physician and medical researcher reflects decades of dedication, expertise, and service to the community.

Where are you originally from, and how long were you at the school? Please indicate the levels you have completed or attended (elementary, secondary, and/or higher education).

I was born in Port-au-Prince, but I traveled all over the country. In 1961, I started in 'sixième' at the school and completed 'la seconde'; then I moved to the U.S. in 1966.

What is your current occupation, and how did your journey, through study, work, or other life experiences, lead you to this role?

At present, I am a fully retired psychiatrist. I remain a physician in good standing, but I no longer see patients and have stepped away from the day-to-day demands of the profession. **My path into medicine was somewhat circuitous**, but in the end, with so many family members already in the field, the decision felt natural rather than difficult.

In what ways has your personal or family life, whether through relationships, children, grandchildren, or other meaningful experiences, shaped your career or personal growth?

I'm not entirely sure how to answer that. My life has felt **meaningful** from the very beginning, and it continues to hold that same depth today. Every stage of the journey has been delightful in its own way.

Is there a particular person, experience, or resource from your school years that you are especially grateful for, and why does it stand out to you?

I had some **memorable teachers** in Diquini. I remember Maître Chaumette, Maître Painson, Miss Raveaux, Miss Robillard, and many others. Interestingly, during my medical internship at Hackensack Medical Center in New Jersey, Robillard was working there as an Emergency Room nurse at the time... go figure.

In what ways do you support your former school or the alumni community, whether through service, mentoring, philanthropy, or other forms of contribution?



Most of my support so far has been through thoughts and prayers. I was told that I donated some electronic equipment, including a fax machine, during the early years of the organization, although I don't personally recall it. I do clearly remember contributing around 2014–15 during an event in Miami.

“Move forward, seize the moment and, as Nike would famously say, ‘Just do it.’”

You also supported our early fundraising efforts. As the year unfolds, what guidance would you offer students and alumni about living a life of service?

I have always believed in **helping people learn how to fish** so they can sustain themselves. That mindset has guided me for years. I'm drawn to efforts that train individuals and help them achieve concrete, lasting goals. In general, I encourage people to move forward, seize the moment and, as Nike would famously say, “Just do it.”

Thank you, Dr. Pierre-Louis, for sharing your insights and perspective from a lifetime in medicine. ▣

“How wonderful it is that nobody need wait a single moment before starting to improve the world.”

Anne Frank

Dominique Bellefleur

We now turn to alumna **Dominique Bellefleur Chrysostome, MSW**, whose journey reflects resilience, curiosity, and more than thirty years of service to her community.

Where are you originally from, and how long were you at the school?

I was born in Les Cayes and raised in Port-au-Prince. I attended l'UNAH (formerly SAFH) in Diquini, from preschool through terminale (Philo C). I still fondly remember my first teacher, Mme **Marie Apollina Bocally**, a kind Guadeloupean lady who introduced me to the joy of learning.

What path did your studies or career take after leaving the school?

After leaving the school, I studied at the Groupe Olivier et Collaborateurs (GOC) in Port-au-Prince. In 1986, during my third year, I moved to the United States. While working in a formal administrative role, I felt drawn to people-centered service and decided to pursue social work. During my internship at Broward County Elderly and Veterans Services Division, I was hired as a full-time case manager and served there for twenty-one years in various roles.

In 2021, during the COVID period, I sensed God leading me into a new chapter. I transitioned to the non-profit sector as Senior Manager of Program Services at The Pantry of Broward, Inc. Today, I serve as Director of Program Services, drawing on the experience gained throughout my career.

Is there a memory, teacher, or experience from your school years that still stays with you today?

God shaped my path in unexpected ways, and I have no regrets. Serving others brings me deep joy. I'm grateful to be fluent in four languages, Creole, French, English, and Spanish, thanks to my secondary-school years. With its motto 'Excelsior,' the institution laid a strong foundation for my life.

What role has your personal or family life played in shaping your values and your work?

Raised in a single-parent home, I watched my mother champion education with unwavering determination. Her resilience became a family legacy: all her grandchildren earned at least a bachelor's degree, and one is now

pursuing a Doctorate in Physical Therapy (DPT).

In what ways do you stay connected to the school or alumni community?

I attended my first alumni meeting nearly twenty years ago in **Sinai SDA Church** in Plantation, FL, with Dr. **Roberne Saint-Louis** who had come to Florida to launch the **South Florida Chapter of CALUNAH**. I became involved immediately and later served as chapter president for several years. My loyalty has never wavered. This is philanthropic work.



“The support we offer to our alma mater, our native country, or our community cannot and should not depend on mood or convenience.”

The theme “Philanthropy” resonates deeply with me. Every day at the pantry, I see retired professionals **volunteering with passion and dedication**. As Christians, we can learn from their example and strive to serve with heart and purpose. I am content with what I have accomplished and take joy in training others as well.

What guidance would you offer to current and former students?

We must live with gratitude. As beneficiaries of this institution, giving back should come naturally. As a ‘Missionnaire Volontaire’ (MV) or ‘Jeunesse Adventiste’ (JA) under the leadership of then Maître Roberne Saint-Louis, I learned respect, loyalty, and commitment to the cause embraced, values that continue to guide me today.

Earlier you mentioned retired professionals who volunteer at your pantry. What is your perspective on alumni who are now professionals?

As professionals, we carry the responsibility of consistency. Giving back becomes a steady practice, a way of honoring our roots and the values that shaped us. Through every storm encountered, to God be the glory for all He has done in my life.

Thank you, Ms. Chrysostome, for sharing your story with such openness and warmth. ☐

Caprices du français

Les jumeaux capricieux : 'Avant que' et 'Après que'

Ils portent le même nom de famille mais chacun a son caractère ; ils refusent de s'habiller 'en uniforme'.

'**Avant que**' est plutôt du type incertain, anticipatoire, un peu inquiet parfois. Alors il utilise toujours **le subjonctif** et souvent ajoute ce petit 'ne' dans un esprit de prudence, de crainte. Le '**ne**' ne marque pas la négation ; on dit plutôt qu'il est 'explétif'.

*Partez maintenant **avant qu'il ne pleuve**.*

***Avant que je te dise** quoi **que ce soit**, j'ai besoin de t'entendre.*

***Avant que Sylvie ait commencé** à parler, tout le monde retenait son souffle.*

'**Après que**', lui, est tout calme, sûr de ce qu'il dit puisque c'est déjà fait, vu, vécu. Il appelle toujours **l'indicatif**, même quand certaines oreilles préfèrent rêver au subjonctif.

***Après que Sébastien avait fini** de parler, la réunion a enfin pu commencer.*

***Après que l'idée a fait** son chemin, chacun a prétendu l'avoir toujours pensée.*

Sans céder à l'influence moderne d' '**Avant que**' sur son jumeau '**Après que**', retenons simplement cette règle-ci :

Avant que ----- le fait ne s'est pas encore réalisé, donc incertain ----- **subjonctif**

Après que ----- c'est un fait déjà accompli, donc certain ----- **indicatif**

La petite sœur rebelle : 'Malgré que'

Dans la famille, elle refuse de se conformer aux règles... Sans demander la permission à ses parents ou du moins à ses frères jumeaux, elle se glisse dans presque toutes les conversations, même les plus élégantes, comme si de rien n'était. Et pourtant, '**Malgré que**' n'est pas la bienvenue officiellement, quoique trop vivante dans l'usage courant. Alors simplifions ici :

Malgré + nom ----- **oui**

Malgré la règle, l'expression continue de faire son petit bonhomme de chemin.

Malgré que + verbe (subjonctif) ----- **NON !!!**

Malgré qu'elle soit proscrite, elle s'invite encore avec cette désinvolture qui déroute plus d'un grammairien.

Pourtant **la forme correcte à retenir, elle, existe bel et bien :**

Bien que + verbe (subjonctif)----- **oui !!**

*Bien qu'elle soit la forme correcte, elle regarde '**Malgré que**' faire son numéro partout...*

Ah, les familles compliquées ! ☐

(LDSL)

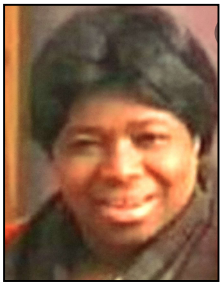
Remembering....

In remembrance, we honor alumni and friends of CALUNAH whose passing has come to our attention, trusting that they now rest, awaiting the resurrection at Christ's return.



We are deeply saddened by the passing of Dr. **Lagny Victor**, a proud alumnus of UNAH, a qualified physician with expertise in aesthetic treatments.

During his years at the university, he distinguished himself both academically and as a gifted, passionate footballer whose presence left a lasting impression on all who knew him. After moving to the United States, he remained closely connected to his roots and became a devoted supporter of CALUNAH, whose representatives were honored to pay their respects at his funeral service in Boca Raton, Florida. We extend our heartfelt condolences to his family, friends, and all who mourn his loss. His memory lives on. May he sleep in God's peace. ▣



Portée par l'esprit de « Un cœur joyeux est un bon remède », Dr **Mona Myrtha Dorsinville-Phanor** vivait une joie rayonnante, enracinée dans la foi. Brilliant of mind - physician, professor, entrepreneur, musician - yet it was her humility and her disarmingly down-to-earth nature that shone most brightly: gracious, grounded, and deeply devoted to the Lord.

Mona a embrassé la mission de CALUNAH avec une dévotion sincère et pleinement assumée : présente, engagée et généreuse. Her support bore the mark of discretion, with contributions often given anonymously. She had hoped to share the mission with her former Harvard colleagues; that hope now rests in stillness as she awaits Christ's return. Yet her legacy endures, and the seeds she planted will continue to bear fruit to the glory of God and the expansion of our organization.

Dans la foi et l'espérance... until we meet again at His call. ▣



Mme **Antonine Bastien** was a remarkable woman whose life was devoted to shaping generations of students at Diquini. Her influence reached far beyond the classroom, leaving a lasting mark on all who had the privilege of learning from her and living under her care. A true *grand mapou* of UNAH, she stood as a pillar of strength, wisdom, and discipline. As a *préceptrice*, she offered structure, guidance, and moral support to countless young women who still carry her lessons today.

CALUNAH honors her memory and stands with her family, her former students, and the generations she touched. May she rest in the peace of the Lord. ▣

Gone, but not forgotten...

Sabine Honoré
Paulette Gracia Theodore
Rose Marie Dorno

Carole Sergile Ogé
Jonas Lamour
Christène Louis

Philanthropy and Christianity

A Commitment to Serving Others

Antoine Nyobe-Nyobe

Philanthropy, understood as a love for humanity expressed through generous and selfless actions, has a natural place in the Christian tradition. From its beginnings, Christianity has encouraged empathy, solidarity, and care for the most vulnerable as essential expressions of a living faith.

This call to compassion invites believers to share time, resources, and presence in ways that uplift others. As the French saying reminds us, « *La philanthropie chrétienne n'est pas un simple acte ponctuel, mais un engagement durable envers la justice et la compassion.* »

In the Gospels, Jesus emphasizes the importance of caring for the poor, the sick, and those on the margins. His generosity went beyond meeting material needs; it restored dignity, hope, and belonging. Christian philanthropy is therefore not a momentary gesture but a sustained commitment to justice and compassion.

“Philanthropy becomes a way of building a more compassionate and supportive world.”

Throughout history, Christianity has inspired remarkable figures whose philanthropic actions have shaped societies and built institutions that endure today. **Saint Francis of Assisi**, for example, embodied simplicity, humility, and a profound love for the poor and the sick. His life of voluntary poverty and care for creation modeled an active solidarity with those in need. Centuries later, **Mother Teresa of Calcutta** carried this same spirit into the twentieth century, founding the Missionaries of Charity and serving the most abandoned through hospices, orphanages, and centers of care, all while spreading a message of universal compassion.

The tradition continued with **Saint Vincent de Paul**, whose organizational genius created networks of assistance for the poor and the sick. His work with the

Lazarists and the Daughters of Charity laid the foundations for modern social services in Christian societies. Even in the realm of health care, **Florence Nightingale** drew deeply from her Christian faith as she transformed hospital sanitation and nursing practices, saving countless lives and restoring dignity to the suffering.



Today, many Christian organizations carry forward this mission through initiatives in health care, education, community support, and poverty alleviation. Their work reflects a faith that inspires action, a faith that sees service not as obligation but as a natural expression of love. Through these efforts, philanthropy becomes a way of building a more compassionate and supportive world.

These figures, among many others, remind us that Christian philanthropy is far more than material assistance. It is a call to transform society with compassion, justice, and humanity. A living testimony of faith in action. ■

Antoine Nyobe-Nyobe, M.A.P.S., M.A. (Private Law), is an officiating pastor at Golgotha SDA Church in Massachusetts. He holds two master's degrees in Pastoral Studies (Oakwood University) and Private Law (Cameroon). He is currently pursuing a Doctor of Business Administration at California Intercontinental University. He and his wife, Pascaline, a teacher, are the parents of 5 young adults.

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